

MAAZ AHMAD SHAIKH

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Professional Summary

Multilingual research and communications professional with eight years of experience spanning academic research, Indigenous Knowledge and oral history research, linguistic quality assurance for major technology clients, translation and localization, training delivery, and administrative and event coordination. PhD in Linguistics (University of Alberta, 2026), with a demonstrated record of managing multi-year projects, competitive research funding, and multilingual documentation to institutional and client standards.

Education

PhD in Linguistics 2026

University of Alberta, Edmonton, Canada

Master of Philosophy in Linguistics 2021

Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi, India

Master of Arts in Linguistics 2019

University of Delhi, New Delhi, India

Bachelor of Engineering in Mechanical Engineering 2017

University of Mumbai, Mumbai, India

Work Experience

Researcher & GIS Specialist Apr 2026 – Present

Kinspeak, on behalf of the Northwest Territory Métis Nation | Remote and field-based

- Lead Indigenous Knowledge researcher and GIS specialist for a federally funded land use and occupancy study, responsible for interview guide design, workplan and budget development, community interviews, and mapping in QGIS and QField
- Research, draft, and edit formal oral history and genealogy reports, coordinating multiple concurrent deliverables to fixed client deadlines and verifying accuracy across 1,150+ pages of archival source material
- Handle sensitive family and community records with discretion, following formal archival standards (RAD, ISAD(G)) and community data governance protocols (OCAP)

Graduate Research & Teaching Assistant Sep 2022 – Sep 2026

University of Alberta, Department of Linguistics, Edmonton, Canada | Part-time during academic terms

- Led four field seasons (8+ months total) of community-based research in remote Ladakh, India, managing logistics, budgets, participant recruitment, and reporting for each
- Built and managed a 36-hour+ audio-video research corpus recorded with 52 participants; deposited three collections in a public digital archive (CoRSAL, University of North Texas)
- Recorded approximately 18 hours of oral literature with two Elder speakers, working within community protocols for consent, attribution, and benefit-sharing
- Designed and delivered a five-day training workshop on documentation methodology for 40+ participants at a college in a remote, low-infrastructure setting, managing curriculum, registration, and logistics independently

- Taught and supported over 100 undergraduate students per term across six courses; guest lecturer in two upper-year courses (2026)
- Wrote and independently administered three competitive research grant applications (Firebird Foundation, Mitacs, Endangered Language Fund) totalling approximately \$18,900 combined, with full budget, procurement, and reporting accountability to each funder

Field Researcher—Comox-Sliammon Documentation

Jan 2023–May 2024

University of Alberta, in collaboration with Elder Molly Harry | Edmonton, Canada

- Completed formal training in Indigenous language fieldwork ethics and community-based research protocols; recorded, transcribed, and annotated an extended narrative with a fluent Elder speaker, continuing the collaboration voluntarily for approximately one year beyond the course's conclusion
- Contributed to a shared lexical database supporting an in-progress community dictionary project

Freelance Hindi Linguist

Jul 2025 – Present

SIDE Global (Hindi AI Training Data Project) | Remote | Part-time

- Perform linguistic quality assurance and localization review on large-scale Hindi conversational datasets for cultural and contextual accuracy
- Apply consistent editorial judgment and style standards across high-volume, fast-turnaround review workflows

Freelance Urdu Linguist

Sep 2022 – Aug 2024

PTW (Google Gemini Urdu Text-to-Speech Project) | Remote | Part-time

- Performed quality control on 10,000+ audio-text alignments for text-to-speech synthesis; managed a lexicon queue covering transcription, pronunciation classification, syllabification, and homograph resolution
- Normalized and proofread scripts for machine learning training workflows

Freelance Translator & Localization Specialist

2018 – Present

Lionbridge and various clients | Remote

- Delivered the first Awadhi-language localization project undertaken at Lionbridge (2020): transcription, verification, and annotation of speech data
- Translated a consumer mobile application into Hindi and Urdu, released on the Google Play Store (10M+ downloads); developed and maintained a style guide for multilingual transcription and translation workflows to ensure consistency across contributors
- Completed the National Translation Mission Intensive Training, Central Institute of Indian Languages, Government of India (2018)

Research Fellow (Junior and Senior)

Jul 2019 – Jun 2022

Jawaharlal Nehru University, Centre for Linguistics, New Delhi, India

- Conducted independent field research in rural Uttar Pradesh, documenting two underdocumented regional languages and developing digital corpora deposited at a public archive, under a competitively awarded government research fellowship (University Grants Commission)

Common Room Councillor, Student Committee

2018 – 2019

Postgraduate Residence, University of Delhi, India | Elected, part-time/volunteer

- Elected to a five-member committee managing residence facilities and services for approximately 200 postgraduate residents; organized cultural, academic, and recreational events throughout the year and represented resident interests with residence administration

Volunteer Heritage Guide for International Visitors

2014 – 2019

Mumbai and Delhi, India | Volunteer

- Led heritage and cultural tours for international student and visitor groups, interpreting local landmarks and adapting communication for non-native English speakers and varied cultural backgrounds

Production Worker & Operations Assistant

Summers 2007 – 2017

Shobha Industries, Mumbai, India (family manufacturing business) | Seasonal and part-time

- Operated industrial equipment (pipe fitting, soldering, drill press, furnace) in small-scale manufacturing, following workplace safety protocols; coordinated packaging, inventory, and distribution across multiple product lines within a team of 10–50 employees
- Sustained this role over ten consecutive years alongside full-time academic study, demonstrating reliability and consistent attendance

Committee Service & Additional Projects

- **Graduate Colloquium Liaison**, University of Alberta (2024–2026): coordinated a departmental speaker series, including scheduling, logistics, and liaison between faculty, students, and visiting presenters
- **Organizing Committee Member**, Alberta Conference on Linguistics (2025): supported abstract review logistics, scheduling, and day-of event operations for a multi-institution conference
- **Scientific Editorial Board Member**, an academic reference grammar (2025–2026), collaborating with co-editors at institutions in France and India
- Developed and published an open-source data conversion tool (Python) supporting spreadsheet-format conversion for structured data workflows

Skills

Languages: Native: Urdu, Hindi | Advanced: English | Intermediate: Marathi, Persian | Elementary: French (actively developing) | Reading knowledge: Arabic, Sanskrit, Tibetan

Research & Documentation: Field research design, data collection and annotation, Indigenous Knowledge and land use research, report writing, archival research and verification, grant writing and financial reporting

Communication: Public speaking and presentation, workshop and curriculum design, cross-cultural and multilingual communication, technical and professional writing, translation and localization

Coordination & Administration: Event and meeting coordination, stakeholder liaison, deliverable and deadline tracking, confidential records management, budget and procurement coordination

Technical: Microsoft Office, Google Workspace, L^AT_EX, Python, R, QGIS, QField, Audacity, Adobe Premiere Pro

Selected Awards & Grants

- Firebird Foundation for Anthropological Research, Oral Literature Grant—USD \$9,990 (2024)
- Mitacs Globalink Research Award—CAD \$6,000 (2023)
- Endangered Language Fund, Language Legacies Grant—USD \$2,910 (2022)
- Ivy A. Thomson and William A. Thomson Graduate Scholarship—CAD \$15,000 (2023–24)
- Doctoral Recruitment Award, University of Alberta—CAD \$5,000 (2022)
- Digital Scholarship Fellowship, University of Alberta—CAD \$1,200 (2024–25)

Additional Information

Status: Post-Graduation Work Permit application submitted; authorized to work full-time in Canada while it is processed

Availability: Available for full-time employment